



A WikiHouse being built at Sharefest

to telling everyone that someone is giving away chocolate recipies but not telling them the ingredients.

This is mostly due to the underdeveloped legal framework surrounding OSHW. Most OSHW licenses are not mature enough yet and leave a lot of room for improvement. The industry also needs to embrace the idea of Open Design rather than using it as a brand of ‘coolness’ to further fill their coffers. That is because open hardware has a lot of promise. Consider the projects like FarmBot, a project aimed at affordable farming technology for efficient food cultivation. There is also WikiHouse, which allows users to download the blueprints and CAD files for different components of houses to be made using a CNC machine, which can be fitted together like a jigsaw puzzle to make a house. That day isn’t far when the computer you purchased online can be 3D printed at your home, or even when you are out shopping, you will command your Google glass to print the Star Wars Lego set you just purchased. From open source solar panels to open source cars and Open source ECG machines, OSHW is truly opening the floodgates to innovation.

Back in the Mid 2000s, when the OSHW movement was once again picking up pace after a brief silence at the turn of the century, one of the primary requirements for Maker projects was a CPU-like device that is